Lesson 4: Project: Automate One Recurring Report

Module 1 | 60 minutes | End-to-end report | Adults (18+) · ages 18–65

Name: Class: Date:

Your mission
Automate one weekly or monthly report from data to delivery, joining a self-updating sheet, a prompt template and a draft email to yourself, with three human checkpoints and an honest time-saved log.

Checklist

- [ ] Pipeline map with checkpoints A (clean), B (numbers) and C (before sending)
- [ ] Sheet with a check column and a dashboard driven by one date cell
- [ ] Saved comments prompt template that uses only the dashboard numbers
- [ ] Draft email to yourself (checked Apps Script or a Gmail/Outlook template)
- [ ] One mistake caught at a checkpoint, explained
- [ ] Time-saved log with before, after (including checks), setup time and payback

Milestones

1. Report chosen, steps mapped and old time measured — done on: _____
2. Sheet, check column and dashboard working — done on: _____
3. Comments template and draft email working (to me only) — done on: _____
4. Full run completed, log filled and payback worked out — done on: _____

Plan it

Write your plan: the problem, who it is for, the AI tools you will use, and how you will check the AI's work.

How it will be marked

Criterion	1 · Beginning	2 · Developing	3 · Secure	4 · Excellent
Pipeline design and checkpoints	Steps unclear; no checkpoints	Steps listed; checkpoints vague or missing one	Clear pipeline with checkpoints A, B and C and who does each	Clear, efficient pipeline; checkpoints placed where mistakes would spread, with a routine card a colleague could follow
Automation quality	Numbers typed by hand each time	Some formulas, but the dashboard does not update from one date cell	Dashboard updates from one cell; template and draft email work	Everything updates and drafts reliably; script checked with all 7 points (or a clean template alternative)
Checking and accuracy	AI numbers or comments used unchecked	Some numbers checked	Every number in the draft checked; one caught mistake explained	Checked, caught mistake explained, and a fix added so it cannot happen again
Measurement and responsible use	No times; private data used	Times without checks or setup	Honest before/after with checks, setup and payback; no private data in AI	Honest log over two runs, payback clear, privacy and draft-to-me rule explained for a manager

Want more?

- Feed the Orders tab from a Google Form so new data arrives by itself
- Add a Monday-morning trigger (or a Power Automate flow; check the current free plan) that emails you the draft
- Add a “sales by item” table and ask the AI to name the top item, then check it against the table

Two stars and a wish

Ask a friend to test your project.

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